How will went from zero to making $4,000

Channel: Takumi Hagino · Published: Oct 12, 2026 · Watch: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=JnEC8VBBvn0 Source: full transcript

📋 Executive Summary

Will, a recent Australian high school graduate stuck in low-paying retail work, discovered Etsy dropshipping through a friend, joined the Easy Etsy program, and earned roughly $4,200 — including $3,600 in the last 30 days alone — within about six weeks.

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🧑 Background: Who Is Will? 0:23

- Will was born and raised in Sydney (western suburbs, Penrith area)
  - His family relocated to Canberra around 2015
  - He now lives in a rural property roughly 40–45 minutes from the nearest city
- He graduated high school the previous year and has been on a gap year since
- He was working in retail during this gap year
  - The long daily commute meant waking at 6:30–7:00 AM and returning home around 6:00–7:00 PM
  - Fuel and car maintenance costs ate heavily into his income

😓 The Pain Point: Retail Work That Went Nowhere 1:50

- His retail wage barely covered bills, fuel, and occasional outings — with nothing left to save
  - He tried to get more hours by making himself available 24/7, seven days a week on the scheduling app
  - Told management to text him any time someone called in sick and he would show up regardless
- He described the feeling as being "stuck at the bottom of a hole with no way out"
- Takumi shared a parallel story for relatability:

- He worked simultaneously at a bakery, a Woolworths supermarket, and an RSL club (a pub/casino-style venue)
- At the RSL he worked night shifts until 6:00 AM, then went straight to a 7:00–8:00 AM bakery shift
- The exhaustion drove him to seek a change — the same motivation Will felt

- Will's weekly cycle: constant anxiety over whether he had enough money to cover the next bill

🔍 Prior Research: Other Online Business Models 3:43

- Will researched dropshipping extensively but never committed to it
  - Was skeptical because of heavy promotion by influencers on TikTok and Instagram
  - Felt most promoters were simply selling courses rather than genuinely running businesses
- The only financial move he made was long-term investing:
  - Putting aside ~$50 per week into tech stock bundles/ETFs
  - He continues doing this alongside the Etsy income
- He had not seriously tried any other online income method before Etsy

💡 The Discovery: How Will Found Etsy Dropshipping 4:48

- Will's entry point was a close friend who was already enrolled in the **Easy Etsy** course/program
  - While visiting the friend's house, Will noticed revenue stats and analytics on the friend's computer
  - Asked what it was; the friend explained it was Etsy dropshipping through the Easy Etsy program
- The friend's results at the time of that conversation (roughly 2 months into the program):
  - About **$4,000** earned in approximately **1.5 months** of serious effort
  - The friend admitted he was lazy in the first month and skipped training modules, then buckled down
- The friend sent Will a link to the program website; Will read success stories and program details
  - Saw that a free consultation was available
  - Booked the consultation the same day he got home — spoke with a team member named Tishen, who explained the program and its incentives
- Takumi noted the value of having an accountability partner:
  - He himself had a close friend join the same program when he started in e-commerce
  - They pushed each other daily to work on listings
- Will and his friend still support each other:
  - They operate in different niches but share the same suppliers
  - They trade knowledge and help each other troubleshoot
  - Every week or two they hop on a call while playing video games and discuss how their stores are performing

📈 Results: $4,200 in Six Weeks 7:24

- **Total earned: ~$4,200** across approximately **1.5 to 2 months**
- **Last 30 days alone: ~$3,600**
  - Meaning roughly $400 was earned in the month before that
- Will showed live proof on his phone during the interview
- Key turning point: activating paid ads
  - Once ads were running, sales "took off immediately" within the first 14 days
  - Growth happened "much faster than expected"
- There is a mandatory ~6-day waiting/review period before selling can begin on Etsy — Will had to wait through this before launching
- The day before the interview, Will received his **first payout deposit** from his Etsy balance
- The early phase required more time investment: setting up the store, creating product listings, etc.
  - Will knew from the start it was a long-term investment, not instant money

🎯 Goals and Future Plans 9:20

- Short-term goal: earn a few thousand dollars per month consistently
- Not aiming to make it a full-time career or lifestyle business — wants it as a **passive income supplement** to gain financial breathing room and time freedom
- Currently running **one Etsy store**; all $4,200 came from that single store
  - Has ideas for additional stores and is researching how best to scale
- Optimistic about **Q4 (October–December)**:
  - Recognizes the holiday season typically drives a major spike in Etsy sales
  - Takumi noted Q4 is roughly a month away at the time of filming and will likely be very lucrative
- Takumi invited Will back for a future interview once he hits **$10,000/month**

🏆 Advice for Beginners 10:27

- "There's no quick way to make money right away — everything is long-term, but trust me, it pays off."
- Patience is essential: it is a long game
- Consistency is the deciding factor:
  - Will stayed consistent for two months and his business is now growing rapidly

    > "Just stay consistent long enough, and it will definitely pay off."

- Takeaway framework from Will's journey:
  - Find a trusted referral source (friend, community) rather than random online promoters
  - Use a free consultation to evaluate the program before committing

- Accept that the first phase is time-intensive (store setup, listings)
- Get an accountability partner to stay on track
- Activate paid ads once eligible — this was Will's inflection point
- Think in months, not days